

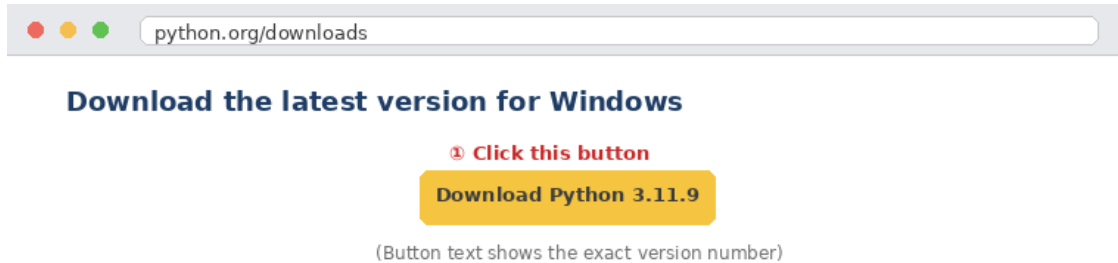
Development Environment Installation Guide

Python 3.11+ • Git • GitHub • VS Code • Cursor AI • Postman

1. Installing Python 3.11+

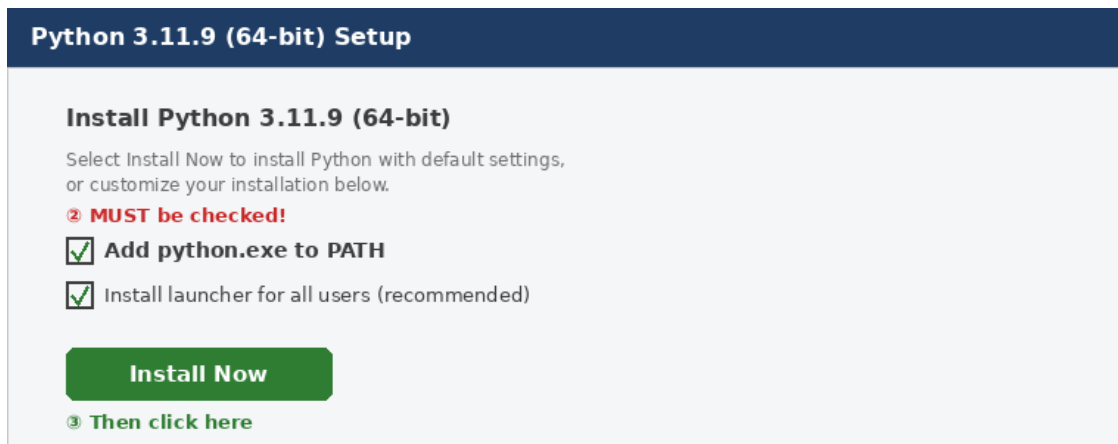
Step 1 — Download the installer

1. Open your browser and go to python.org/downloads.
2. Click the yellow "Download Python 3.11.x" button.
3. Make sure the version shown is 3.11 or higher before downloading.



Step 2 — Run the installer correctly

1. Open the downloaded installer file.
2. On the very first screen, tick "Add python.exe to PATH" (Windows) — this is the single most important step.
3. Click "Install Now" and wait for it to finish.



If you skip "Add to PATH", typing python in a terminal later will fail with "not recognized". You'd then need to reinstall or edit PATH manually — so don't skip it.

Step 3 — Verify the installation

Open a terminal (Command Prompt / Terminal) and run:

```
python --version
```

You should see something like "Python 3.11.9". If you get an error, open a fresh terminal window (PATH changes only apply to new terminals) and try again.

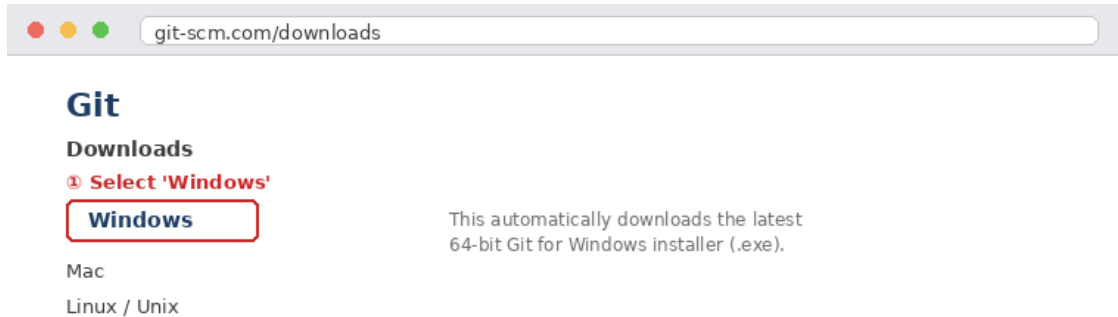
```
Command Prompt

C:\Users\Zahra> python --version
Python 3.11.9
```

2. Installing Git

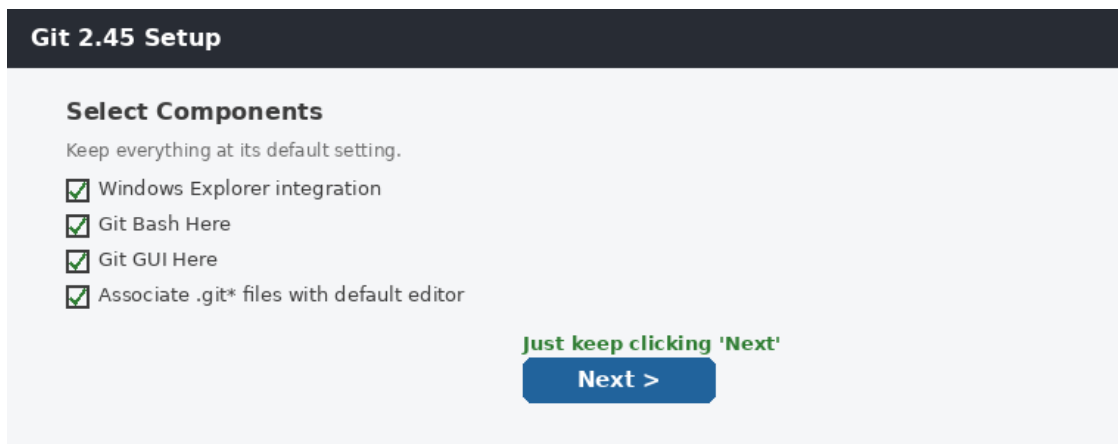
Step 1 — Download the installer

1. Go to git-scm.com/downloads.
2. Click your OS (Windows / Mac / Linux) — download starts automatically.



Step 2 — Run the installer

1. Open the downloaded installer file.
2. Keep every setting at its default value.
3. Keep clicking "Next" through each screen, then "Install" on the last one.



Step 3 — Verify the installation

Open a new terminal and run:

```
git --version
```

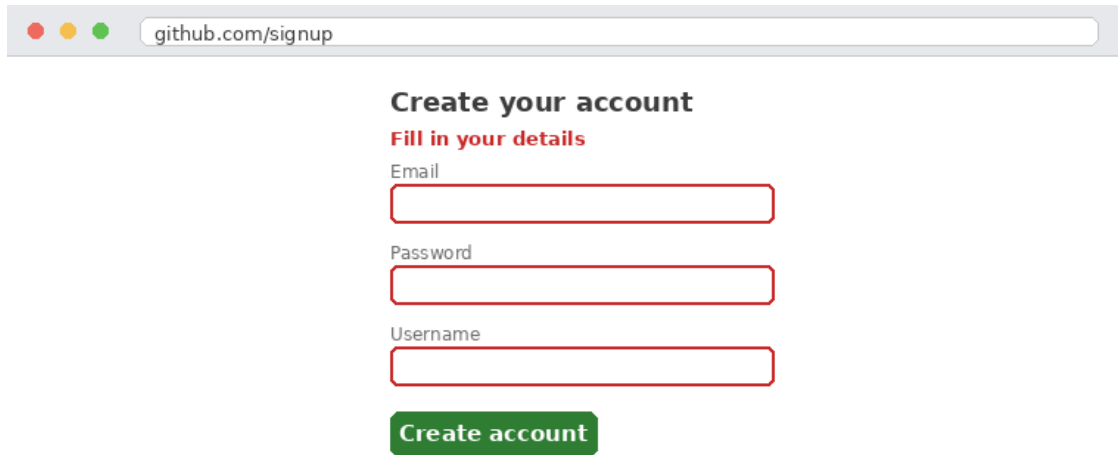
You should see something like "git version 2.45.1".

```
Command Prompt

C:\Users\Zahra> git --version
git version 2.45.1.windows.1
```

3. Creating a GitHub Account

1. Go to github.com/signup.
2. Enter your email address, create a password, and choose a username.
3. Complete the verification puzzle if prompted, then verify your email via the confirmation email GitHub sends.

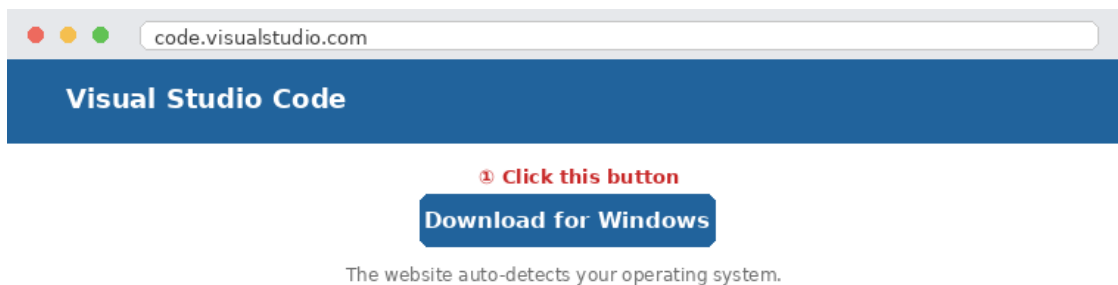
A screenshot of a web browser window showing the GitHub signup page. The address bar displays 'github.com/signup'. The page has a white background with a light gray border. At the top, it says 'Create your account' in bold black text, followed by 'Fill in your details' in red. There are three input fields: 'Email', 'Password', and 'Username', each with a red border. Below these fields is a green button with white text that says 'Create account'.

Once verified, you can log in at github.com and create repositories — this is where all fellowship assignments are submitted from Week 1 onward.

4. Installing VS Code

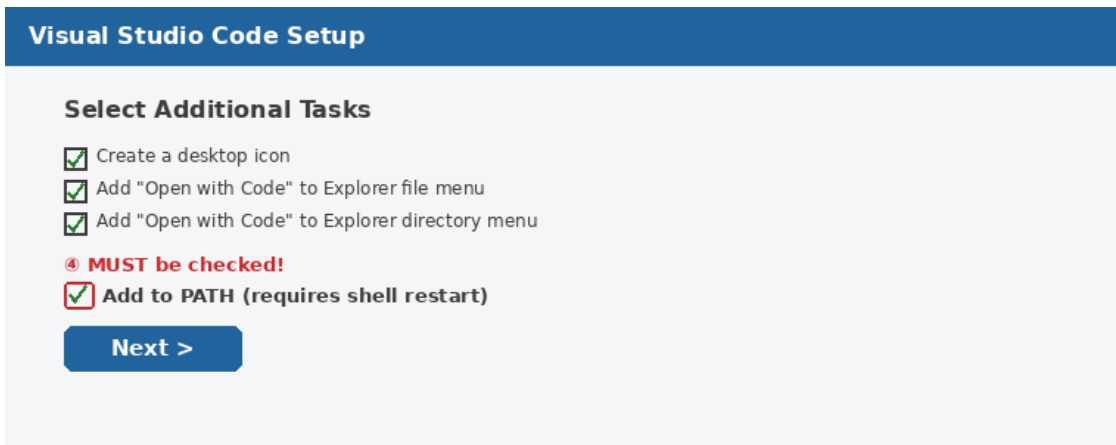
Step 1 — Download the installer

1. Go to code.visualstudio.com.
2. Click "Download" for your operating system.



Step 2 — Run the installer

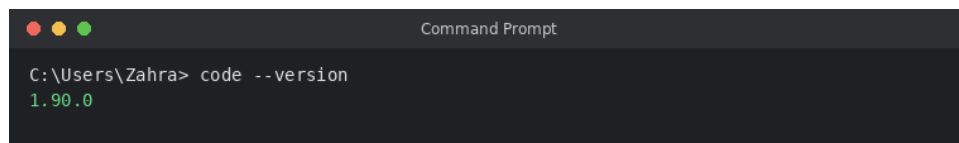
1. Open the downloaded file and accept the license agreement.
2. On "Select Additional Tasks", make sure "Add to PATH" is ticked (usually on by default).
3. Click "Next", then "Install".



Step 3 — Verify the installation

Open VS Code from the Start menu once to confirm it launches. Optionally verify from the command line:

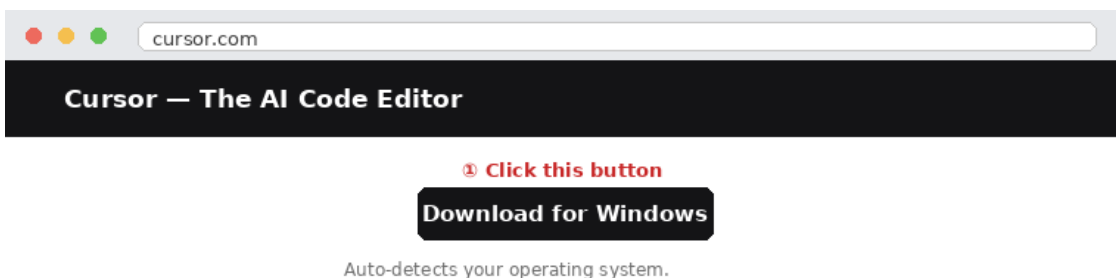
```
code --version
```



5. Installing Cursor AI

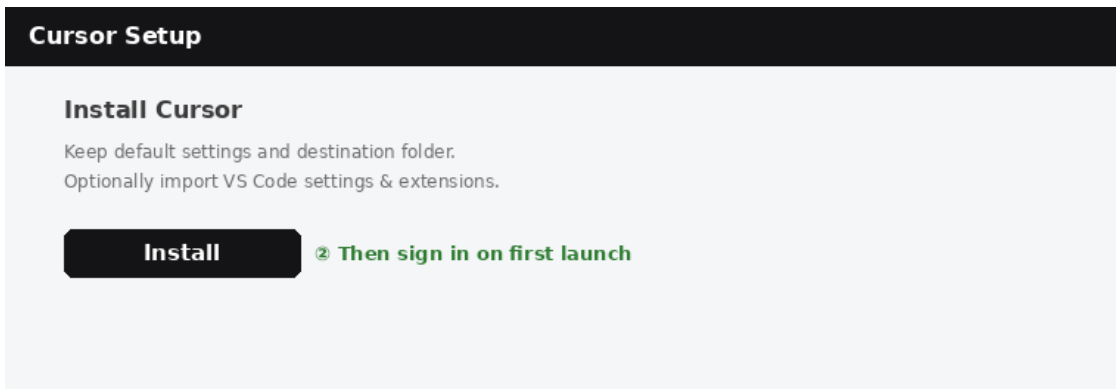
Step 1 — Download the installer

1. Go to cursor.com.
2. Click "Download" for your operating system (Windows / Mac / Linux).



Step 2 — Run the installer

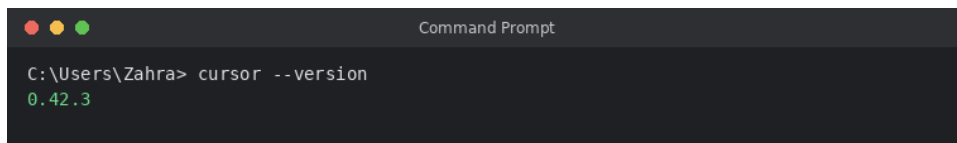
1. Open the downloaded file and follow the setup prompts, keeping defaults.
2. On first launch, sign in or create a Cursor account, then optionally import your VS Code settings/extensions when prompted.



Step 3 — Verify the installation

Open Cursor from the Start menu/Applications once to confirm it launches. Optionally verify from the terminal (if the command-line tool was installed):

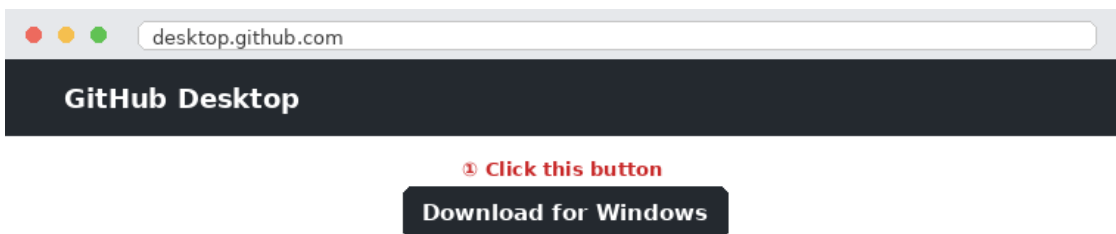
```
cursor --version
```



If `cursor --version` isn't recognized, that's fine — the command-line shortcut is optional. Confirming the app opens is enough.

6. Installing GitHub Desktop

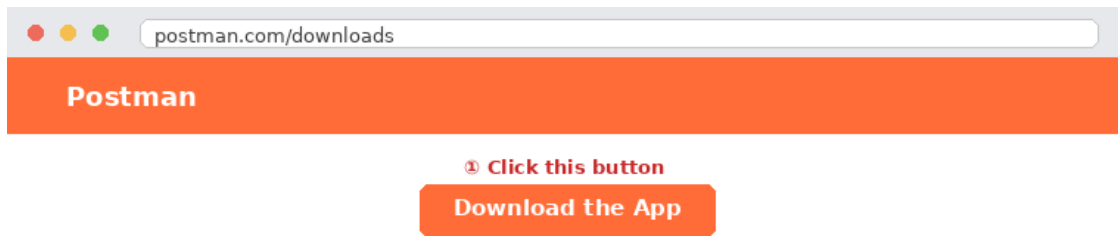
1. Go to desktop.github.com.
2. Click "Download for Windows" (or Mac).
3. Open the installer, then sign in with your GitHub account when prompted.



GitHub Desktop gives you a visual way to clone, commit, and push repositories without typing Git commands — useful if you prefer a GUI over the terminal for submitting assignments.

7. Installing Postman

1. Go to postman.com/downloads.
2. Download and run the installer for your operating system.
3. Launch Postman and sign in or continue without an account.



Postman is useful for manually testing API calls (e.g. Google Gemini API or OpenAI API requests) before wiring them into your Python/Streamlit code.

8. Installing Python Packages

These packages are needed for the fellowship assignments (Gemini/OpenAI API calls, Streamlit apps, config, and data validation).

Step 1 — Create a virtual environment (recommended)

```
python -m venv venv
```

Activate it:

```
venv\Scripts\activate (Windows) source venv/bin/activate (Mac/Linux)
```

Step 2 — Install the packages

```
pip install openai streamlit python-dotenv requests pydantic
```

```
Command Prompt

C:\Users\Zahra> pip install openai streamlit python-dotenv requests pydantic
Collecting openai
  Downloading openai-2.44.0-py3-none-any.whl
Collecting streamlit
  Downloading streamlit-1.58.0-py3-none-any.whl
Requirement already satisfied: python-dotenv, requests, pydantic
Successfully installed openai-2.44.0 streamlit-1.58.0 python-dotenv-1.2.1
requests-2.32.3 pydantic-2.11.9
```

Step 3 — Verify the installation

```
python -c "import openai, streamlit, dotenv, requests, pydantic; print('All packages OK')"
```

```
Command Prompt

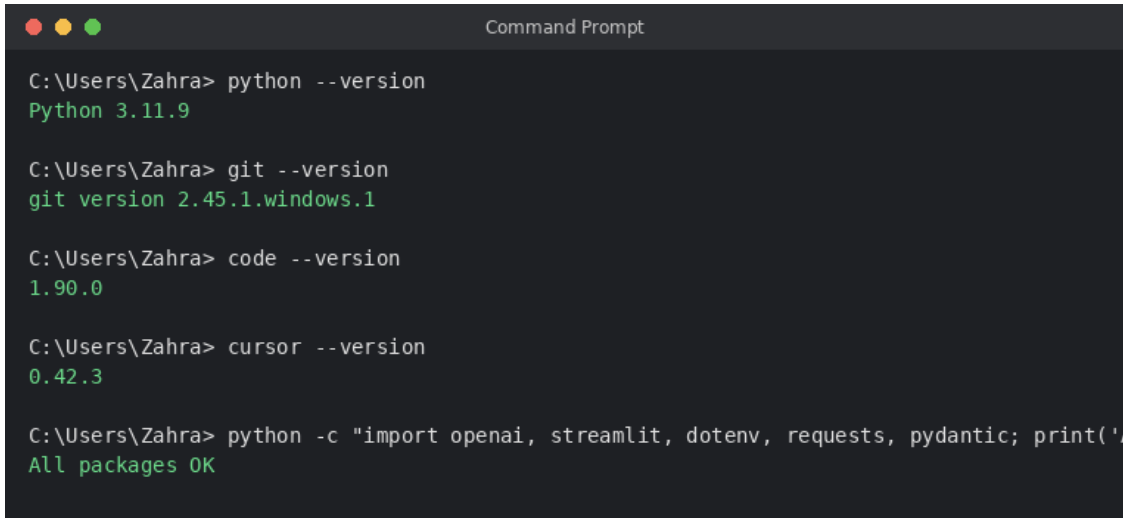
C:\Users\Zahra> python -c "import openai, streamlit, dotenv, requests, pydantic; print('All packages OK')
All packages OK
```

If this prints "All packages OK", all five packages are correctly installed.

9. Final Check — All Tools Together

Open a fresh terminal window and run all checks one after another, to confirm everything is installed and on PATH correctly:

```
python --version git --version code --version cursor --version pip show openai  
streamlit python-dotenv requests pydantic
```



```
Command Prompt

C:\Users\Zahra> python --version
Python 3.11.9

C:\Users\Zahra> git --version
git version 2.45.1.windows.1

C:\Users\Zahra> code --version
1.90.0

C:\Users\Zahra> cursor --version
0.42.3

C:\Users\Zahra> python -c "import openai, streamlit, dotenv, requests, pydantic; print('All packages OK')"
```

If every command returns a version number (not an error), your development environment is fully set up and ready for Week 1 of the fellowship.